1. A designer working for a client designs a book for an exhibition. Different people photograph the artwork and write texts for the book.

Can the designer claim a kind of clear agenda or authorship over the final product?

- ○ No, only people who are writers can claim authorship.
- ○ No, work for hire agreements with a client assigns authorship only to the client.
- ○ Yes, everything a designer does has an agenda.
- ◉ Yes, designers working in collaboration with editors, writers, and photographers can produce work that has a signature vision.
- ○ Yes, a client can legally assign authorship to a designer.

✓ **Correct**

A designer does not need a particular context or legal ownership in order to have a recognizable agenda or vision.

2. **Which of the following could be considered an *agenda* in graphic design practice?** Select all that apply.

- [ ] The use of digital or analog tools (i.e. Photoshop, screen printing)
- [ ] A clear visual hierarchy
- [x] A signature visual style

✓ **Correct**

In a more traditional sense a designer can be recognized as having a kind of agenda or authorship through the unique formal qualities of their work.

- [x] An intent to spread awareness of social and political issues

✓ **Correct**

An agenda can extend to how design is used and that includes using design as a tool to create awareness around social/political issues

3. A motion graphics piece is designed to advertise a new car for a car company.

In this scenario, can the fact that the piece is an advertisement prevent the designer from having a clear agenda?
Select the best answer.

- ○ No, the designer cannot have a clear agenda because advertising is not design.
- ○ Yes, the designer can have a clear agenda if the piece is well-crafted.
- ◉ Yes, the designer can have a clear agenda because the piece could have a separate agenda apart from the need to sell cars.
- ○ No, the designer cannot have a clear agenda because in this scenario, their work can only promote the corporation's agenda.

✓ **Correct**

A designer's agenda can be articulated in a commercial context if there is a common purpose between a client and a designer.

Still On, Still Off

BEFORE

AFTER

Reviewed May. 19, 2014 by Armin

Comments (31)

INDUSTRY / ENTERTAINMENT

TAGS / #BLUE #GRETEL #IFC #ON-AIR

Launched in 1994 and owned and operated by AMC Networks, IFC (Independent Film Channel) is a television channel with a mix of kooky, serious, and pop-culture-y programming. From original comedy series like *Portlandia* and *MARON* to "classic" movies like *Scarface* and *Napoleon Dynamite*, IFC is one of the most entertaining and least pandering channels available. This month it introduced a new identity and on-air look designed by New York, NY-based Gretel.

4. Look at this image depicting the logo of IFC, an independent film television channel, before and after its redesign. **How does the redesign shown on the right respond to the prompt of being "always on, slightly off"?**

New Logo, Identity, and On-Air Look for IFC by Gretel **Reviewed**

Still On, Still Off

BEFORE AFTER

Reviewed May. 19, 2014 by Armin **Comments (31)**

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Tip: You may find it helpful to read the accompanying article text about the entire redesign process, "Still On, Still Off: New Logo, Identity, and On-Air Look for IFC by Gretel".

- ○ It creates a pun by using a bold, dynamic typeface to signify “off.”
- ○ High contrast makes this logo highly memorable and difficult to forget.
- ◉ Using extrusion (3D effect) for the letters and slightly angling the logo subtly signifies “offness” through the form of the type.
- ○ A lack of color in the logo is highly unusual and signifies difference and “offness.”

✓ **Correct**

Offness is being interpreted visually here as jumping into the third dimension from two dimensional space.

IFC

ALWAYS ON

- [x] The use of randomness and visual chaos.

> ✓ **Correct**
> The visual style of the video is a bit random and visually chaotic, but it does seem to match IFC's brand and content.

- [x] The quirky use of stacked and bold type.

> ✓ **Correct**
> IFC's brand appears to be based on a kind of indy, DIY approach to film. The style and use of type in the video reinforces the brand.

- [ ] The minimalist, two-tone color scheme.

- [x] The use of appropriated scenes from movies shown on IFC to create a comedic effect.

> ✓ **Correct**
> This kind of appropriation emphasizes IFC's "slightly off" brand. Also, the visual language of this editing style is obviously influenced by the supercut style of viral video montage

- [x] The frantic editing style

> ✓ **Correct**
> The frantic editing style is an effective visual translation of IFC's brand.

How well does this design convey IFC's brand language of "always on, slightly off"? Look carefully at how the logo is animated, there is something very wrong about it. Is this an effective use of sequence? Think about how the animated GIF uses a very simple sequence and at the same time subverts expectations of what the sequence should be doing.

Write at least a couple of sentences, using the Critique Framework to justify your answer.

Critique Framework v3.pdf
PDF File

Correct

Read the following description and compare it to your answer:

This animated GIF was deliberately designed to be a kind of optical illusion with a fake perspective. If you look closely at the gif there is a visual sleight-of-hand where the spinning logo, as it turns away, shows the front of the logo as opposed to the back. This is cleverly edited and crafted. It is just "off" enough to be a subtle gesture that underlines the IFC brand and its quirky "offness." If you look at the Critique Framework and think specifically about the Sequence/Narrative category, this is a very strong use of sequence. But it is highly unorthodox, since it is deliberately building a sequence the "wrong" way.